

Liturgy for Planting

A Liturgy for the Planting of Trees and Gardens

A Celebration of Creation Resilience

The Gathering

The community gathers around the planting site. The officiant begins:

Officiant: The earth is the Lord's and all that is in it.

People: The world and all who dwell therein.

Officiant: For God has founded it upon the seas and established it upon the rivers.

People: We gather today to do our part in caring for the earth that God has entrusted to us.

Officiant: Almighty God, in giving us responsibility for things on earth, you made us fellow workers in your creation: Give us wisdom and reverence so to use the resources of nature, that no one may suffer from our abuse of them, and that generations yet to come may continue to praise you for your bounty; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen. (BCP Prayers and Thanksgivings 41. For the Conservation of Natural Resources, edited) [cite: 1]

The Reading

A member of the congregation reads from the book of Genesis (1:27-30, the Message).

God spoke: "Let us make human beings in our image, make them reflect our nature so they can be responsible for the fish in the sea, the birds in the air, the cattle, And, yes, Earth itself, and every animal that moves on the face of Earth."

God created human beings; he created them godlike, reflecting God's nature. He created them male and female. God blessed them: "Prosper! Reproduce! Fill Earth! Take charge! Be responsible for fish in the sea and birds in the air, for every living thing that moves on the face of Earth."

The Blessing of the Gardeners, Soil, Water, and Plants

Officiant: Gracious Lord, you created the earth and filled it with all manner of living organisms. They form ecosystems according to your design, with each member striving to achieve your goal. You created mankind as stewards to tend your magnificent gardens for the benefit of all beings, great and small. You appointed each of us to do our part in maintaining the balance of nature so that we may live in peace and harmony with all our brothers and sisters, sharing in the bounty of Your creation.

Bless our hands as we gently tend Your garden.

People: May our humble efforts serve to glorify Your creation.

Officiant: Soil is much more than an aggregate of particles of sand, small stones, clay, and organic matter. Proper garden soil is alive with various organisms of different sizes and functions, along with a balance of beneficial nutrients.

Guide our efforts as we prepare this soil to provide nourishment and support for these plants to thrive.

People: May our labor strengthen this garden in its ability to nourish these plants.

Officiant: Heavenly Father, your precious gift of water sustains all life. Since the beginning of creation, when the Holy Spirit moved over it, all living things have been forever linked through its wondrous properties.

May our knowledge and skills ensure that this garden is properly prepared to utilize the water provided by nature and require minimal intervention from its stewards.

People: May our humble efforts serve to maintain balance in nature.

Officiant: Gracious Heavenly Father, by Your Word, every plant was created to be an integral part of Your garden. We all suffer when the balance and harmony in our environment are disrupted.

We thank you for these native plants/trees, designed by your hand to thrive in this portion of your creation for which we are the chosen stewards.

People: May they thrive and strengthen the bonds between us and your creation.

Officiant: We bless this soil, that it may be a womb for growth. We bless this water, that it may be a source of strength. We bless these plants, that they may provide shade for the weary, oxygen for the living, and a home for the small creatures of the air.

People: Lord, make us faithful stewards of this place and gardeners of your grace.

The Act of Planting

As the tree is placed in the ground or the seeds are sown, the people may say together:

As we tend this garden of your creation, we commit ourselves to:

- Shelter those who suffer from the heat of the world.
- Conserve the precious gift of water.
- Protect the diversity of the life you have made.
- Hope for a future where all creation flourishes together.

The Dismissal

Officiant: Go forth into the world as stewards of the Earth. Be rooted in love, growing in hope, and bearing the fruits of the Spirit.

People: Thanks be to God. Amen.